



PHISHING AWARENESS

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Recognize · Resist · Report

3.4B

Phishing emails/day

36%

Breaches involve phishing

\$17,700

Lost per minute to phishing

1 in 99

Emails is a phishing attack

What Is Phishing?

Phishing is a cybercrime where attackers impersonate legitimate organizations via email, text, or fake websites to steal sensitive data — passwords, credit card numbers, and personal information.

Email Phishing



Mass emails mimicking banks, services, or employers.

Smishing / Vishing



SMS texts or voice calls used to trick victims.

Spear Phishing



Targeted attacks with personalized, convincing details. Mainly high profile targets.

Pharming



Redirecting users to fake websites silently.

Recognizing Phishing Emails

Simulated Phishing Email

From: security@paypa1-alert.com

To: you@company.com

Subj:  Urgent: Verify account now!

Dear Valued Customer,

We detected suspicious activity. Click the link below IMMEDIATELY or your account will be suspended in 24 hours.

 <http://paypa1-verify.xyz/login>

Regards, The PayPal Security Team

1

Misspelled Domain

paypa1 vs paypal — zero vs letter 'l'

2

Urgency & Threats

"Suspended in 24 hours" forces hasty decisions

3

Suspicious URL

paypa1-verify.xyz — not paypal.com

4

Generic Greeting

"Valued Customer" — not your actual name

5

Unexpected Request

Legit companies never ask for credentials via email

Spotting Fake Websites

→ LEGITIMATE WEBSITE

https:// in address bar with padlock

Exact domain: paypal.com

Professional layout, no typos

No pop-ups begging for info

Contact info and privacy policy present

SSL certificate from trusted authority

VS

→ FAKE / PHISHING WEBSITE

http:// only OR fake padlock icon

Misspelled: paypa1.com / pay-pal.net

Poor design, broken images, typos

Aggressive pop-ups demanding login

No footer, no about/contact pages

Self-signed or expired SSL cert

Social Engineering Tactics



URGENCY & FEAR

Most Common

"Your account will be locked in 1 hour!" — panic overrides rational thinking. You panicked you got trapped.



AUTHORITY

High Impact

Impersonating CEO, IT dept, banks, or government agencies to demand compliance. Most common at organizational level.



TRUST & FAMILIARITY

Spear Phishing

Using your name, company details, or recent purchases to appear legitimate.



RECIPROCITY

Common Lure

"You've won a prize!" — offering something free to lower your guard.



SCARCITY

Retail Scam

"Only 2 spots left" — creating false rarity to push immediate action.



PRETEXTING

Enterprise Risk

Fabricating a scenario (fake IT support, audit) to extract credentials.

Real World Examples

2016

Democratic National Committee

Tactic: Spear Phishing Email

A staffer clicked a malicious link in an email disguised as a Google security alert, exposing 50,000+ emails.

💡 Always verify sender emails and visit sites directly — never via links.

2020

Twitter / Bitcoin Scam

Tactic: Vishing + Social Engineering

Attackers called Twitter employees, posed as IT staff, and gained access to internal tools — hijacking accounts of Musk, Obama, and Apple.

💡 Verify caller identity through official channels before providing any access.

2023

MGM Resorts (\$100M Loss)

Tactic: LinkedIn + Vishing

Attackers found an employee on LinkedIn, called the IT help desk pretending to be them, and reset MFA — causing a 10-day outage.

💡 Help desks must verify identity with secondary authentication, never just a name.

Best Practices & Defense Tips

01

Hover Before You Click

Always hover over links to preview the real URL. If it doesn't match the expected domain, don't click.

02

Enable Multi-Factor Auth

MFA stops 99.9% of account compromise attacks even if your password is stolen.

03

Verify via Separate Channel

If an email requests sensitive action, call the sender using a number from the official website — never from the email.

04

Keep Software Updated

Patched browsers and OS block known vulnerabilities that phishing sites exploit to install malware.

05

Use a Password Manager

Password managers autofill only on the correct domain — they won't fill in credentials on a fake site.

06

Report Suspicious Emails

Use your email client's 'Report Phishing' button. Early reporting protects your entire organization.

The S T V Framework

When you receive a suspicious email or message:

A large, bold, red letter 'S'.

STOP



Don't click, reply, or download anything. Pause and breathe.

A large, bold, orange letter 'T'.

THINK



Ask: Do I expect this? Does the sender match? Is there urgency?

A large, bold, teal letter 'V'.

VERIFY



Contact the sender through a trusted, independent channel.

Quick Reference Checklist

✓ Check sender email domain carefully

✓ Hover over links before clicking

✓ Look for HTTPS + valid certificate

✓ Verify requests through official channels

✓ Use MFA on all critical accounts

✗ Never click links in unexpected emails

✗ Never provide passwords via email or chat

✗ Never trust urgency without verification

✗ Don't open unexpected attachments

✗ Don't ignore browser security warnings

✓ Report suspicious messages to IT

✓ Keep browser & OS fully updated

✓ Use unique passwords + password manager

✓ Attend regular security training



Stay Alert. Stay Safe.

Phishing attacks succeed because of human error — awareness is your strongest defense.

Key Takeaways:

Think before you click • Verify the sender • Report suspicious activity • Use MFA everywhere

THANK YOU